

Topic 4: Biodiversity and natural resources

This topic begins with a comparison of the structure of a typical plant cell with that of an animal cell, and the structure and roles of cellulose and starch. The relationship between plant tissues, xylem and sclerenchyma, is also included. The topic continues with a consideration of the importance of plant products to humans, species diversity, and how diversity arises through natural selection and evolutionary change. The role of zoos in the conservation of endangered species is also described.

2.2 Assessment information

This unit is assessed by means of a written examination paper, which carries 80 marks, lasts 1 hour 30 minutes and will include:

- objective questions
- structured questions
- short-answer questions

and will also cover:

- *How Science Works*
- practical-related questions.

Students may use a calculator.

The quality of written communication will be assessed in the context of this unit through questions which are labelled with an asterisk (*). Students should take particular care with spelling, punctuation and grammar, as well as the clarity of expression, on these questions.